



# Approaches to Disability

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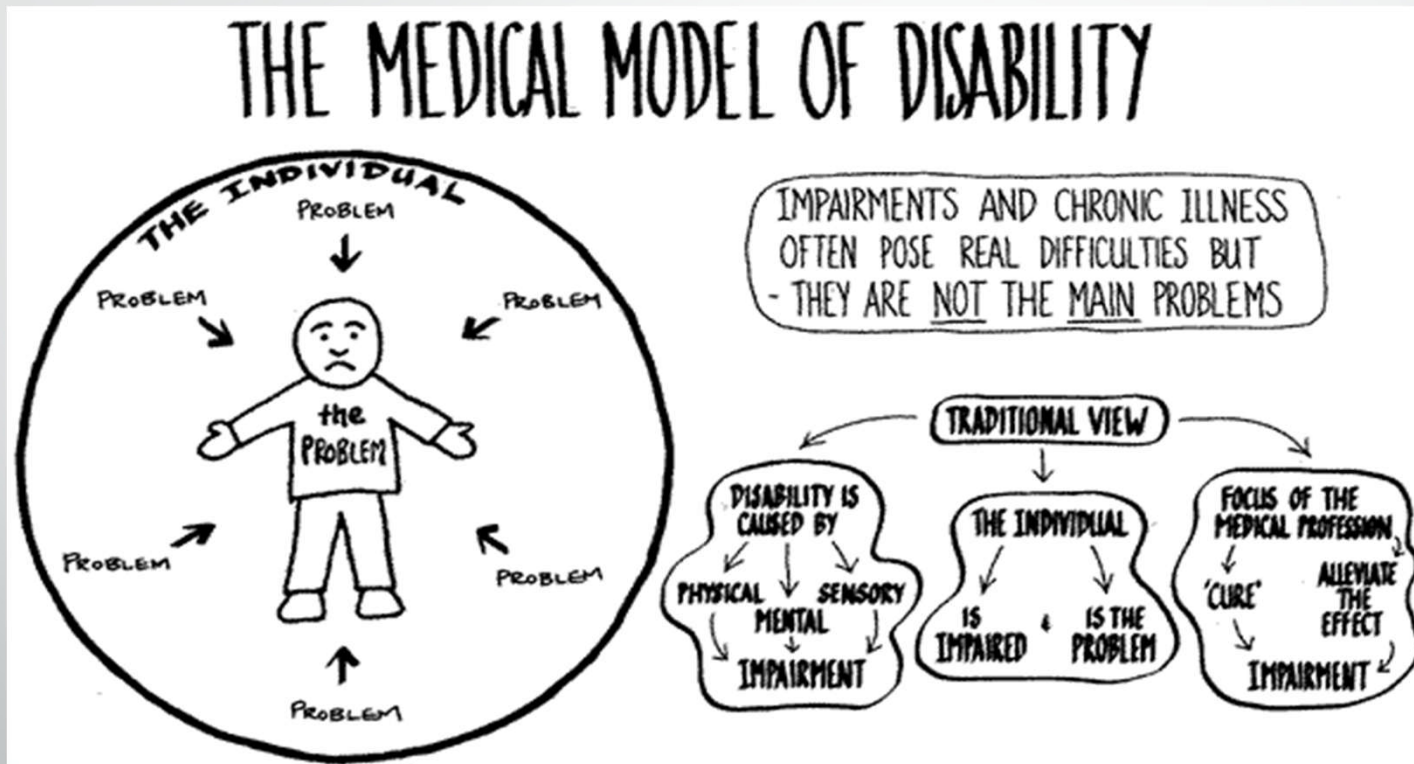
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# Overview of this Unit

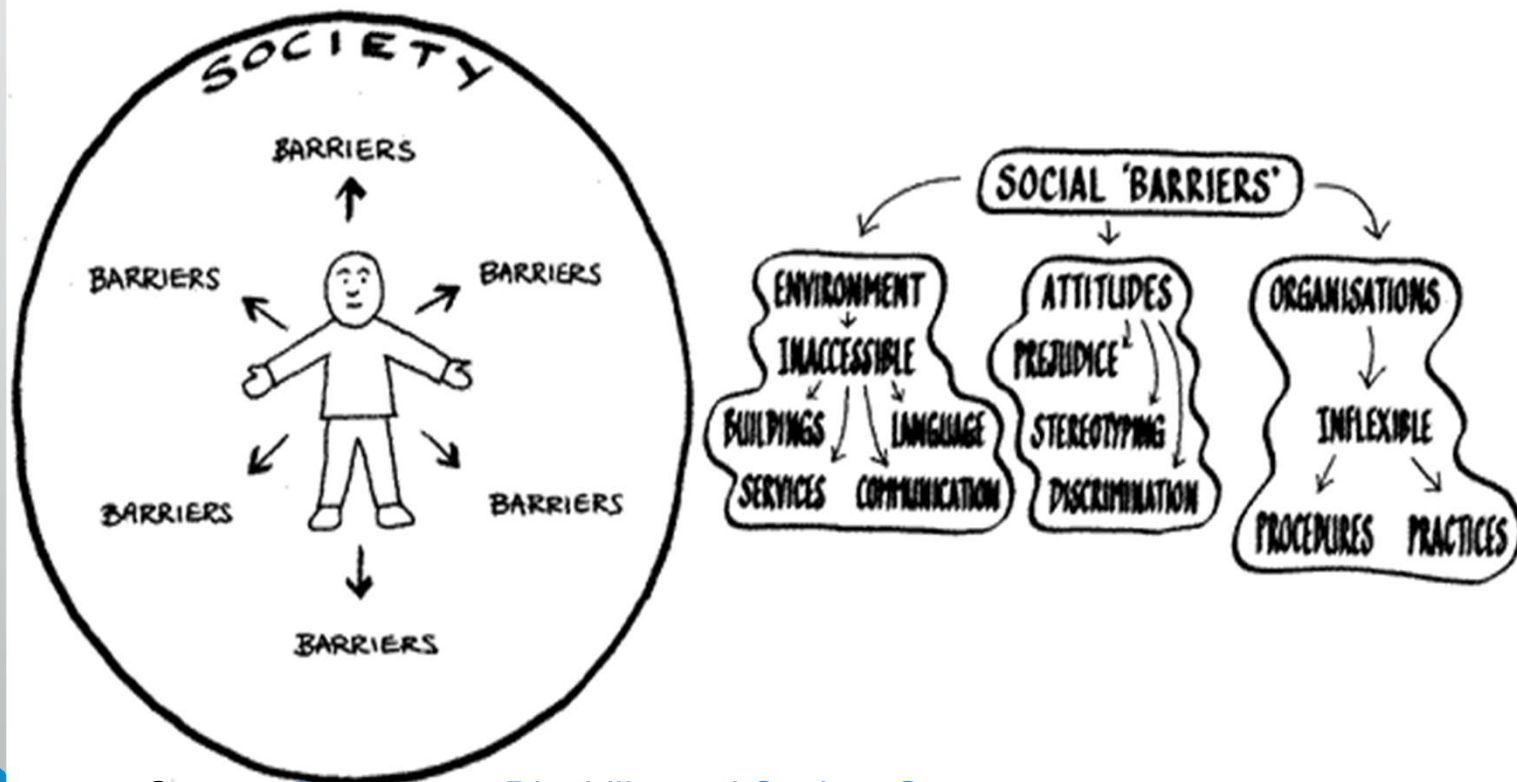
- Approaches to understanding disability
- Strength based Approach; Rights based Approach, Cross-disability approaches
- Barrier free environment, Inclusive development, Multidisciplinary rehabilitation team and their roles
- Research in disability management; Role of Technology in dealing with disability, Fitment of aids and appliances
- Organizations working in the area of disability

# Models of Disability



Source: [Democracy Disability and Society Group](#)

# THE SOCIAL MODEL OF DISABILITY



Source: [Democracy Disability and Society Group](#)

# Strength- Based Approach to Disability

- Focuses on the strengths and resources of the person, rather than their problems or deficits
- Assess psycho-social issues, functional strengths, ambitions, desires, resources and support systems
- Person-centered approach – believe that the PWD is an expert of their own life with self-esteem and self-determination.
- **Goal** - to help them experience self-discovery and come up with solutions that are unique to their specific context and strengths.

# Rights-Based Approach



- Focus is on viewing the PWD **as a human first**
- Recognize disability is a natural part of humanity
- Emphasize the right of every individual to be treated equally before the law
- Person's impairment not an excuse for denying them rights
- Goal - they have equal opportunities and protect their right to fully participate in society, politically, civilly, socially, culturally, and economically
- **United Nations Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities** - introduced a paradigm shift in the understanding of disability, **from a welfare or medical model toward a model based on the rights of people with disabilities.**

# EQUAL



*All human beings are born free & equal.*  
- UNIVERSAL DECLARATION OF HUMAN RIGHTS  
1948

# Inclusive Development

- According to UN Convention – inclusion refers to
  - Respect for inherent dignity,
  - Individual autonomy including the freedom to make one's own choices,
  - Independence of persons,
  - Non-discrimination,
  - Full and effective participation and inclusion in society,
  - Respect for difference and acceptance of persons with disabilities as part of human diversity and humanity

# Inclusive Development.....

- Disability-Inclusive-Development (DID) – all stages of development process should be inclusive and accessible to PWD.
- All persons be afforded equal access to education, health care services, work and employment, and social protection.
- PWD should be included in development process as participants and beneficiaries.
- Have the opportunity to participate in every aspect of life to the fullest extent possible.
- Opportunities include participation in education, employment, public health programming, community living, and service learning.

# Cross-Disability Approaches

- Cross-disability refers to the approach of **treating all disabilities as one collective experience**, rather than treating them as separate, distinct issues
- Rationale – PWD face similar barriers and challenges irrespective of the specific type of disability they face

## Example: Cross Disability

- People with physical disabilities, sensory disabilities, intellectual disabilities, and mental health disabilities all face barriers to accessing education, employment, healthcare, and other essential services.
- They may also experience discrimination, stigma, and exclusion based on their disability.

## Cross Disability Approach .....

- Requires the involvement and participation of people with disabilities in all aspects of decision-making and policy development that involves them.
- Policies and programs then can be more effective, responsive, and inclusive.
- Requires commitment to social justice and human rights.
- Recognizes the inherent dignity and worth of all people with disabilities.
- Challenges any discrimination and exclusion based on disability.

# Barrier Free Environment

- The word “barrier” means obstruction that is stop the person to do something what he wants to do.
- Barrier free environment is one where anybody can move without any help, freely and safely as they want. For Eg: Freedom and choice to move around the world.
- When a person has some disability, he has to face some challenge for movement or doing anything like a person without disability.

## Barrier....

- Social, economical, physical, information/ communication, technology and attitudinal barriers in day to day life.
- Barrier to access basic needs like education, employment, healthcare and social support systems.
- RPWD Act 2016 promotes barrier free facilities in all Govt buildings, public utilities, roads and transport.

## Barrier Free Provisions

- Assistance of ramps, elevators/lifts, stair railings and handrails, Entrances, Reception, Doors, Corridors, Restroom/Toilets, Classroom, Library, Conference Hall/Auditorium, Cafeteria, Hostel.



## Fitment of Aids and Appliances

- The Scheme of Assistance to Disabled Persons for Purchase/ Fitting of Aids/Appliances (ADIP Scheme) is an endeavor of the Government to provide the disabled persons with aids/appliance at minimum costs.
- The Scheme aims at helping the disabled persons by bringing suitable, durable, scientifically-manufactured, modern, standard aids and appliances within their reach.

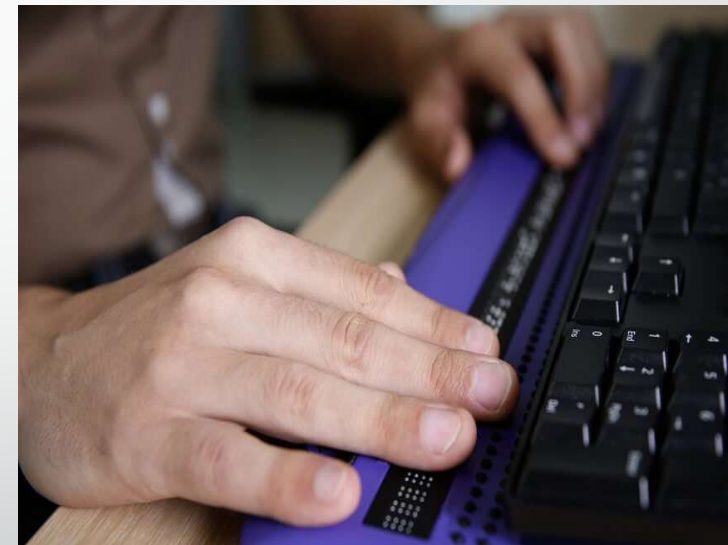
# Role of Technology

- Rehabilitation involves equipment used to aid these people as they perform their tasks. Rehabilitative technologies make their lives much better and reduce the impact of their disabilities.
- Technologies is to feel a part of society and lead a near-normal life.
- The assistive devices help people with special needs to dress and groom themselves. Some quite easy but effective modification helps them to reach far away from lights and doorbells, which are some of their many uses.

# Assistive technologies

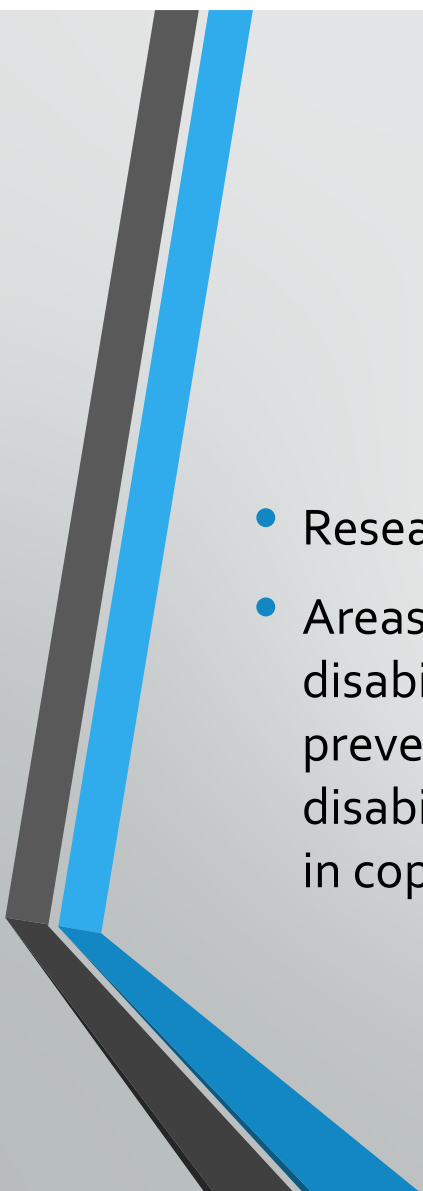
- An assistive technology device can be defined as “any item, piece of equipment, or product, whether it is acquired commercially, modified, or customized, that is used to increase, maintain, or improve the functional capabilities of individuals with disabilities”.
- Common examples of assistive devices are:
  - crutches, prostheses (artificial limb), orthoses (orthopaedic brace), wheelchairs, and tricycles for people with **mobility impairments**;
  - hearing aids and cochlear implants for those with **hearing impairments**;
  - white canes, magnifiers, ocular devices, talking books, and software for screen magnification and reading for people with **visual impairments**;
  - communication boards and speech synthesizers for people with **speech impairments**;
  - devices such as day calendars with symbol pictures for people with **cognitive impairment**.

## Some Examples



# Multidisciplinary Rehabilitation Team

- Team of professionals who are representatives from different disciplines.
- Approach disability from their own perspective
- Each member works towards a cohesive treatment or management plan, parallel towards a common goal for the PWD.
- Team members work in coordination and collaboration.
- Eg: Physician, psychiatrist, physiotherapist, occupational therapist, rehabilitation counsellor, social worker, psychologist, nursing etc.



# Research in Disability Management

- Research in field of disability is an ongoing activity.
- Areas include not limited to – exploring causative factors, application of disability theories, impact and effectiveness of legislations, policies, preventive and rehabilitative measures, scope for better management of disability, use of AI in living with disability, capacitating PWDs and families in coping with disability etc.

# Organizations for Disability

- **International Disability Alliance** – alliance of network of over 1,100 organisations of PWDs, their families from across eight global and six regional networks.
- **World Disability Union –**
- International Committee of the Red Cross (ICRC)
- Handicap International - Community-based Rehabilitation
- WHO (disability and rehabilitation team)
- Action on Disability and Development- India - works in South India
- Workability International
- Christian Blind Mission International (CBM)

# Accessible India Campaign

- Department of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities (DEPwD, GoI) launched Accessible India Campaign (Sugamya Bharat Abhiyan) as a nation-wide campaign for achieving universal accessibility for Persons with Disabilities (PwDs) on December 3, 2015.
- It has three important verticals, namely – the Build Environment, the transportation sector and the ICT ecosystem.



## Part A: Built Environment Accessibility

- Measures should be undertaken to eliminate obstacles and barriers to indoor and outdoor facilities including schools, medical facilities, and workplaces.
- Includes all public spaces such as roads, footpaths, parks and gardens etc.



## Part B: Transportation System Accessibility

- Transportation is a vital component for independent living, and like others in society
- PwDs rely on transportation facilities to move from one place to another.
- **Objective is to enhance proportion of accessible airports, railway stations and public transport**



## Part C: Information and Communication Eco-System Accessibility

- Access to information creates opportunities for everyone in society.
- Accessibility to read price tags, enter a hall, participate in events, read pamphlets, view webpages, read train time table etc. (Infrastructural barriers)



Thank You